



Compile

The F9 key is all too familiar to coders. Some of the most phenomenal inventions in the modern age including social networking, e-commerce and web services have been the handiwork of talented devs. Under the compile section we cater to these obscure, reclusive and often times eccentric professionals we've come to love and celebrate.

The Cloud Conundrum

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As cliched as it may sound, there is no denying the fact that cloud computing services have been and are continuously revolutionizing the ways in which we develop and deploy our applications and websites. The problem that developers and system designers are facing right now is the problem of plenty, it's like a kid in a candy shop. There are many companies out there providing similar services and thus the users are completely stumped when it comes to choosing between the services.

There are a lot of famous providers out there Amazon AWS, Rackspace, Google Cloud Computing, IBM Smart-Cloud, Windows Azure, Joyent, Heroku, Linode, OpenShift and countless more. There is no definitive answer to which provider is the best, the answer may vary depending on whom you ask. Each

application or website is unique in its requirements and problems, only you as its system architect or a developer will be able to make the correct decision on which provider will suit you the best. This article will discuss some of the important points that need to be taken into consideration before locking in on a particular provider, and though not making the decision for you, it will set you down the correct path.

Operations

Cloud service providers offer their services in either (or both) of these two paradigms: Infrastructure as a Service and Platform as a Service. Under IaaS, the provider is responsible for providing instance(s) of machines as per the user specifications. The resources available for each instance can be scaled on demand, i.e. you can increase or decrease the number of CPUs, RAM or storage

through a web control panel or an API. The catch here is that the managing this virtualized hardware is onus on the developer, the provider is not responsible for managing these systems for you. So applying security updates and patches, upgrading the system, trouble shooting and other maintenance tasks all have to be carried out by the user.

On the other hand we have PaaS, this model sits above IaaS in the cloud computing model and provides the user with an execution runtime, frameworks, operating systems, database and web servers. Developers can run their software on the cloud platform without worrying about the complexity of the underlying hardware and software. Most of providers out there also automatically scale the resources on the underlying hardware to match the demand.

Which software model to go for is dependent entirely dependent on how